

### 1 Be sure (double-check and be sure again) about the industry

Okay, this is technically something that you ought to think of way before you come to the decision of beginning a venture, but it never hurts to have a re-think and evaluate all your options once more does it? Especially if rethinking could mean the difference between the success and failure of your business venture.

So, here's the deal: one of the most important things to think about when starting your own business is the industry



that you are thinking of getting into. The industry should be one that has good growth potential, not to mention enjoying some traction in the current scenario – it wouldn't do anything for your parents' peace of mind if every time they ask you how the business is doing, the only answer you have to give is, "Just waiting for the industry to pick up ma/da."

### 2 Study the competition

This is something that you should be doing all the time – not just when starting the business. For there are two things that are definitely going to help you keep afloat in the long run – knowing your enemy and drinking a whole lot of coffee.



To begin with, you can visit your competitor's store or establishment and check out the processes that they follow and the type of customers they serve. Of course, you'd have to do so in stealth mode, meaning you should be able to derive some excitement out of it,

provided you've read enough John Le Carre novels. Also, sign-up for newsletters etc. that the competitor sends out and keep track of their marketing activities, both online and offline.

You'll have plenty of worry-filled moments after seeing their strengths in various departments. But once these moments pass and relative calm settles in, you can begin to seek out their weak points. And these are the areas you can try and strengthen for your own business, possibly giving your brand strong USPs that the competition can't compete with.

### 3 The funding

When starting a business, an important factor that one needs to keep in mind is the funding. If you can't manage to somehow fund yourself, you can look for funding from other sources. While ideally funding yourself is the safest bet, it's not unheard of for businesses and startups to look for and get funding from other businesses and



organisations. However, in this case, funding could be a double-edged sword. Being funded here could actually mean that some other organisation practically owns you – taking away a lion's share of your profits. You may even receive cryptic mails with subjects like "Concerns" and "Future?".

While their funding does indeed fuel your growth, you've gone from being the boss of your own startup to a stressful employee of some other much larger organisation. So try as much as possible to fund yourself, and only fallback on other options as a last resort.

